

# S004 StrideOne Footwear - Dropship Onboarding and Integration Project

Project Document | Operations

|                     |                       |                |                  |
|---------------------|-----------------------|----------------|------------------|
| Document ID         | PRJ-S004-001          | Seller ID      | S004             |
| Department          | Operations            | Classification | CONFIDENTIAL     |
| Owner               | Neha Gupta            | Created Date   | 2025-10-06       |
| Related Scenario ID | Not scenario-specific | Document Type  | Project Document |

## 1. Purpose

This document records the onboarding of StrideOne Footwear Pvt. Ltd. (S004) and the delivery of its dropship integration. StrideOne holds no inventory of its own; orders are routed to third-party logistics partners who hold brand stock. The integration therefore had to solve a routing problem and a catalogue problem that earlier onboardings did not present.

## 2. The Dropship Model

In a conventional marketplace integration the seller owns stock, knows where it is, and dispatches it. StrideOne owns none of these things.

- Stock is held by four third-party logistics partners, each with its own systems and its own view of availability.
- Product data originates with the partners, not with StrideOne.
- Dispatch is performed by the partner, so StrideOne never physically inspects a product before it reaches a customer.
- Returns are received by the partner, so return reason data flows back through the partner rather than from StrideOne.

The practical consequence is that StrideOne's listing quality is a function of partner-supplied data. The platform's published product specification, including the size chart, is derived from a feed the seller does not author.

## 3. Timeline

| Date       | Milestone                                | Outcome                                  |
|------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 2025-06-17 | Commercial agreement signed              | Gold tier, fortnightly settlement        |
| 2025-07-01 | KYC and brand authorisation verification | Four brand authorisations on file        |
| 2025-07-15 | Partner onboarding, three 3PL partners   | Approved                                 |
| 2025-08-05 | Dropship feed contract agreed            | Attribute schema fixed                   |
| 2025-08-26 | Routing logic implemented and tested     | Partner selection by stock and geography |
| 2025-09-09 | Catalogue pilot, 2,400 SKUs              | 6.1 percent attribute rejection rate     |

| Date       | Milestone                   | Outcome                         |
|------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 2025-09-22 | Go-live                     | Account activated, ~14,000 SKUs |
| 2025-10-06 | Two-week review and closure | Passed, two open items          |
| 2025-12-04 | Fourth 3PL partner added    | Routing extended                |

## 4. Integration Design

### 4.1 Order Routing

An order line is routed to a partner based on declared availability, delivery geography and partner SLA. Routing is evaluated at order placement, not at dispatch, so a partner stock-out after routing produces a cancellation rather than a re-route. This was accepted at design time as a simplification; it remains the largest known weakness in the design.

### 4.2 Product Feed

Partners deliver product data on a schedule. The feed importer normalises brand, colour, material and size attributes into the platform catalogue schema.

Size is the most complex normalisation. Partners supply sizes in UK, EU or US conventions depending on brand, and the importer converts to a single published size chart. The conversion table is maintained by the platform.

This conversion is the component that failed in August 2026, when a schema update caused the UK-to-EU conversion to be applied twice. The design note below was written at onboarding and proved prescient.

Design note from August 2025, recorded verbatim in the original plan:

"Size conversion is the only transformation in this feed that cannot be validated by inspecting a single record. A wrong colour is obvious; a wrong size is only detectable by comparing the published chart against the physical product or against return data. Validation must therefore be structural rather than per-record."

The structural validation implied by that note was not implemented at onboarding. It was deferred as open item OI-2 and delivered only in August 2026 after the defect occurred.

### 4.3 Returns

Return reason codes flow from the partner to the platform. The codes relevant to this account are size-too-small, size-too-large, not-as-described and quality. Return rate is monitored because it drives both reverse logistics cost and, through the risk rules engine, account standing.

## 5. Commercial Configuration

| Area                  | Configuration                                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Tier                  | Gold                                          |
| Commission            | 17.4 percent average, fashion band            |
| Settlement            | Fortnightly, T+3 payout                       |
| Returns reserve       | 5 percent of cycle value held against returns |
| Return window         | 14 days including size-and-fit exchanges      |
| Return rate threshold | 25 percent triggers automated account review  |

The T+3 payout lag and the 5 percent reserve are both dropship-specific. They exist because returns on this model land after settlement has been computed, so a portion of cycle value must be held back.

The 25 percent return rate threshold was configured at onboarding as a standard fashion-category risk rule. At the time nobody considered what would happen if a platform-side defect drove the return rate above that threshold.

6. Pilot Findings

The September 2025 pilot covered 2,400 SKUs from two partners.

- Attribute rejection rate 6.1 percent, mostly missing material declarations.
- Routing correct for 99.4 percent of test orders; failures were geography edge cases at delivery-area boundaries.
- Size conversion verified by manual sampling of 60 SKUs. All correct.
- Return flow tested with 40 simulated returns; reason codes propagated correctly.

The manual sampling of 60 SKUs is worth noting. It confirmed that the conversion table was correct at that moment. It could not, and did not, confirm that the conversion would remain correct after a future schema change.

7. Open Items at Closure

| ID   | Item                                         | Owner       | Target     | Outcome                           |
|------|----------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|-----------------------------------|
| OI-1 | Re-routing on post-routing partner stock-out | Engineering | 2026-03-31 | Deferred, still open              |
| OI-2 | Structural validation of size conversion     | Engineering | 2026-01-31 | Delivered 2026-08-19 after SC-006 |

8. Handover

| Function                | Owner        | Department  |
|-------------------------|--------------|-------------|
| Operational ownership   | Neha Gupta   | Operations  |
| Technical support       | Vikram Singh | Engineering |
| Platform administration | Admin        | IT          |

S004 is held in the seller scope of Neha Gupta only. Commercial matters on this account are handled by Operations with Business consulted at review points, which is a deliberate consequence of the scope model.